# Needs Assessment Project
# The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs)

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## 1.0 - Project Summary

### 1.1 - Description of client

The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs) takes an important role in the department, not only connecting students between laboratories and campus, also assisting to hold seminars, events, and interviews for upcoming students.

The SAPPs aim to promote interaction among students, postdoctoral associates, and faculty in the Plant Pathology department at the University of Georgia. It also strives to enhance graduate programs, student teaching, and professional development. With 7 office members and growing representation from Tifton, plans are underway to expand the society for improved connection and efficiency.

### 1.2 - Project objectives

The goal of the needs assessment project revolves in improving the organization communication between members and organizing tasks and jobs responsibilities. The four primary needs were defined with the client in the beginning of the project, they are listed below.

- **Identify the tasks of SAPPs.**

Due to the increased number of the students, SAPPs will redistribute the tasks and responsibilities of each officer, including holding events, connecting departments, liaisons and SAPPs.

- **Clarify the job descriptions of officers in SAPPs.**

Define responsibilities and divide activities by the job descriptions on SAPPs. The SAPPS works are divided into

  - President
  - Vice-President
  - Treasurer
  - Secretary
  - Social Chair
  - Tifton Liaison
  - Griffin Liaison.

- **Organize methods of communication between members**

Establish a structured system for organization members, incorporating synchronous and asynchronous communication channels for collaboration and information dissemination. Offer solutions for members reliant on online feedback and updates, ensuring efficiency and reliability.

- **Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison**

Analyze the interactions between group members and the Liaison group members, identifying possible barriers, logistical constraints and possible hindrances of collaboration with the objective of formulating strategies to mitigate and promote interaction.

## 2.0 - Data Collection Tools

Tailored data collection tools were created for the SAPPs needs assessment, delving into organization functionality, member interactions, communication methods, and task completion. Concurrently, member roles and responsibilities were revised to ensure clarity, with each tool aimed at confirming or adjusting client-stated needs.

To pinpoint SAPPs tasks, analysis of the 2023-2024 Constitution was coupled with interviews with the president and vice president. This review aimed to uncover past roles and understand present responsibilities. Surveys and documentation further clarified role responsibilities and member understanding, particularly through a survey assessing communication methods and technology issues completed by five out of seven members.

The table below demonstrates how each data collection tool fulfills specific needs, guiding subsequent analyses. All tools are documented in the project's appendix section.

**Data Sources Informing Needs**

| Need | Document analysis data collection | Interview data collection | Survey data collection |
|---|---|---|---|
| Identify the tasks of SAPPs | X | X | |
| Clarify the responsibility of each role in SAPPs | X | | X |
| Organize methods of communication | | X | X |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| between members | | | |
| Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison | | X | X |

### 3 - Findings

Listed below are the data gathered by each individual data collection tool, prior to the overall analysis.

### 3.1 - Findings within the Document analysis data

| Task | Yes | No | Comments |
|---|---|---|---|
| **President** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is simple and focuses on meeting management. |
| The description of the role is well defined | | X | The description of the role on the document only encompasses organizing, overseeing and participating in meetings. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | X | The description of the role on the document only encompasses organizing, overseeing and participating in meetings. |
| **Vice President** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is simple and focuses on providing assistance for the president. |
| The description of the role is well defined | X | | The vice president duties are depicted focusing on providing assistance to the president and being responsible for the blueberry picking sale event. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | X | The document describes vaguely at means to provide assistance to the president and not explain all the duties of organizing the blueberry picking sale event. |
| **Treasurer** | | | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is defined and explained. |
| The description of the role is well defined | X | | It informs the description of the role, but There is a need for more information. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | X | There is a need for more information of all duties performed by the treasurer. |
| **Secretary** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is defined and explained. |
| The description of the role is well defined | X | | The description of the role covers all events that the position requires. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | X | | It describes all duties required for the task completion. |
| **Social chair** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is defined and explained. |
| The description of the role is well defined | X | | The description of the role covers all events that the position requires. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | X | | It describes all duties required for the task completion. |
| **Tifton/Griffin Liaison** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | X | | The purpose is defined and explained. |
| The description of the role is well defined | X | | The description of the role is simple. |
| The duties of the role is well explained | X | | It describes the tasks, but lacks details on planning the events and designating tasks. |
| **Additional information** | | | |
| The document is well written | X | | The document is easy to follow and comprehensible. |
| The document cover all the information needed for new office members | | X | The document covers all basic information needed for members, but lacks some information focused on specific roles. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| the document covers role position changes and for extenuating reasons | X | | The document provides insights for position changes and possible abnormal scenarios. |

The analysis of the SAPPs constitution reveals a lack of comprehensive information for members to fulfill their roles independently. Many tasks are presented simplistically, leaving gaps in understanding. For instance, the president's role mainly focuses on organizing meetings. The treasurer's duties require more detail. However, the section on potential position changes meets satisfactory standards.

### 3.2 - Findings within the interview information data

- **Tasks in SAPPS**

The SAPPs office has 7 members with rotating roles, mainly in Athens for events. Positions include president, vice-president, treasurer, secretary, and social chair, with liaisons at Tifton and Griffin campuses. New members learn from the Constitution and predecessors and the president leads meetings and events, while the treasurer manages finances. Liaisons oversee campus tasks.

“They know about the roles of each officer,but I'm not exactly sure about the members of the whole department.so sometimes you think that they may have rights issues knowing which they probably would know most of the thing, but like for some of the roles it is really ambiguous. For I was there like 80% of the job was done by the president himself.”

- SAPPs Vice president

- **Communication methods**

Tasks are typically assigned monthly, with members working independently. The president and vice president collaborate closely, and all members work together for group events. Monthly meetings allow for task feedback and event planning, typically held in person with optional Zoom participation. Communication throughout the week is primarily via text or email.

“I get feedback from the officers at meetings. Sometimes whenever you know something needs to be done, they usually let me know about it. But we have monthly meetings that we adhere to and so that's a way I can get feedback.”

- SAPPs president

- **Collaboration with other liaison**

UGA has three Plant Pathology campuses besides Athens, which house the majority of students and five of the seven SAPPs office members. Communication challenges exist between Athens office members and liaisons due to a focus on in-person meetings, leading to reported issues in coordination.

“We have other different sets like campus and we kind of feel the lack of connection across campus sometimes like for some of the members from the other campus.I don't really know their names or I'd heard about them and they were never seen in person.”

- SAPPs Vice president

- **UGA’s financial system and resources**

Interviews revealed challenges in managing financial duties between the organization and UGA. Constant policy changes hindered fund allocation and reimbursements. Members faced frustration with complex processes and bureaucratic hurdles.

“I have to avoid the university system when it comes to money because it's just a black box, for me and even our treasurer too, you know, do the best he can getting reimbursement forms. And we still don't know how the reimbursement form actually gets put into that.”

- SAPPs president

### 3.2 - Findings on the survey data

**Here are the questions we would like to answer throughout the survey:**

| **Question 01: Is there any issue or barrier for communication with the three selected ways?** | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Email (Q4) - I don't have issues with cultural barriers via email | 3.2 | 3 | 3 |
| Email (Q5) - I don't have issues with language barriers via email | 3.8 | 3.5 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q13) - I don't have issues with cultural barriers communicating in meetings via zoom | 3.6 | 3 | 3 |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Zoom (Q14) - I don't have issues with language barriers communicating in meetings via zoom | 3.4 | 3 | 3 |
| F2F (Q20) - I don't have issues with cultural barriers on Face to face Meetings | 3.4 | 3 | 3 |
| F2F (Q21) - I don't have issues with language barriers on Face to face Meetings | 3.4 | 3 | 3 |

| **Question 02: How clearly does the member receive tasks and feedback?** | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Email (Q2) - I understand my tasks clearly when received by email | 4 | 4 | 4 |
| Email (Q7) - I am satisfied with the feedback I receive via email | 3.6 | 4 | 4 |
| Zoom Q10) - I understand my tasks clearly when received verbally by zoom | 4.2 | 4.5 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q11) - I understand my tasks clearly when received in the chat by zoom | 4 | 4.5 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q16) - I receive good feedback from my peers via zoom | 4.2 | 4 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q17) - I receive good feedback from my superiors via zoom | 3.8 | 3.5 | 4 |
| F2F (Q19) - I understand my tasks clearly when received in Face to face Meetings | 4.4 | 4 | 4 |
| F2F (Q23) - I receive good feedback on Face to face Meetings | 4.8 | 5 | 5 |

| **Question 03: How comfortable are the members to convey the ideas through three communications?** | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Email (Q6) - I can convey my ideas clearly via email | 4 | 4 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q15) - I can convey my ideas clearly via zoom | 3.8 | 3.5 | 4 |
| F2F (Q22) - I can convey my ideas clearly on Face to face Meetings | 4.2 | 4 | 4 |

| Question 04: How satisfied are the members to receive feedback in an ideal time among three methods? | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Email (Q6) - I can convey my ideas clearly via email | 4 | 4 | 4 |
| Zoom (Q15) - I can convey my ideas clearly via zoom | 3.8 | 3.5 | 4 |
| F2F (Q22) - I can convey my ideas clearly on Face to face Meetings | 4.2 | 4 | 4 |

- Clearly receive the task - no significant differences.
- Clearly convey the ideas- Zoom meeting is the lowest one, the other two are basically the same.
- Language barrier and culture issues- no significant differences.
- Receive feedback in a satisfactory time- Email is the lowest while F2F meeting is the highest.
- In general, the SAPPs members have positive experience related to three communication methods. (none of the median is below 3)

**4 - Relating the data**

The data analysis shows a need to update the previously identified needs for more precise intervention recommendations for the organization. Additionally, the table below offers further details on potential data discrepancies.

**Determining Consistencies and Discrepancies among Data**

| Need | Data Sources | Consistencies among Data Sources | Discrepancies among Data sources | Comments |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Identify the tasks of SAPPs | Document analysis Interview | Both data sources showed some ambiguity in defining the tasks. | Members reported performing tasks beyond those outlined in the constitution during the interview. | Tasks vary greatly among role members, with many not specified in the constitution or ambiguously defined. |
| Clarify the responsibility of | Document analysis Survey | Both sources indicate a | Members knew their role but | The responsibilities lack definition and |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| each role in SAPPs | | certain degree of familiarity with each role responsibility | lacked knowledge of others', as revealed in interviews. | details. |
| Organize methods of communication between members | Interview<br>Survey | Both data sources indicate that the members knew how to use the methods of communication | Data showed good communication between members, although the interview stated lack of online communication, specially with liaison members. | Lack of definition of main forms of feedback and protocol for assistance. |
| Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison | Interview<br>Survey | Neither data source mentioned significant communication issues that could impede organizational tasks. | Only the interview mentioned communication issues with liaison members and the absence of online interaction. | The organization requires additional direct input and feedback from both liaisons. |
| Collaborate with faculty members at the UGA's financial system and resources | Interview | | | Certain role members, like the treasurer, require faculty guidance to effectively fulfill their duties. |
| Offer resources guides for new members | Document analysis<br>Interview | The interview and document analysis noted a lack of resources beyond direct mentoring to guide new organization members. | | New members need to create a new methodology to organize events and to complete tasks due to the lack of a previous framework. |

**5 - Addressing the causes of the needs**

- The Constitution doesn't reflect the actual member's responsibilities.

- Communication gaps between campuses due to distance and preference for face-to-face meetings.
- Annual events connecting campuses could foster better collaboration among members.
- UGA's bureaucratic hinder the treasurer tasks and events planning
- Tasks involving funds lack guidance, with the treasurer focused mainly on reimbursements.
- UGA Bureaucracy hinder SAPPs of university resources

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**6 - Recommendations**

**Data outcome associated with Needs**

| Need | Support data to verify need | Level of urgency | Priority | Magnitude | Potential resources required to address the need |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Identify the tasks of SAPPs | Organization Constitution, Interviews | Major | Moderate | Low cost / Moderate changes | Updated constitution |
| Clarify the responsibility of each role in SAPPs | Organization Constitution, Interviews | Major | Moderate | Low cost / Moderate changes | Updated constitution, group meeting |
| Organize methods of communication between members | Interviews, Survey | Critical | High | Low cost / Major changes | Collaborative platform such as Google drive, group chat platform |
| Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison | Survey, Interviews | Major | Low | Low cost / Major changes | Group meeting |
| Collaborate with faculty members at the UGA's financial system and resources | Interview | Major | High | High cost / Major changes | UGA Financial System guideline, UGA financial faculty |
| Offer resources | Organization | minor | Moderate | Low cost / Moderate | Collaborative |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| guides for new members | Constitution, Interview | | | changes | platform such as Google drive |

**Time Required to Address Needs**

| Need | Time to Address | Individuals to be Involved | Potential Resources Needed | Dependency on Other Needs or Organizational Actions |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Identify the tasks of SAPPs | Less than 1 year | SAPPs executive board member | SAPPs Constitution, department faculty | Foundation of the organization and will highly influence other needs. |
| Clarify the responsibility of each role in SAPPs | Less than 1 year | SAPPs executive board member | SAPPs Constitution, | Will highly influence the effectiveness of other needs. |
| Organize methods of communication between members | Less than 1 year | SAPPs executive board member | Team building workshop, collaborative platform | Highly related to and will affect organizational actions and other needs. |
| Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison | Less than 1 year | SAPPs executive board member, department faculty | Team building workshop, collaborative platform | Moderate dependency to other needs, but will highly influence SAPPs tasks. |
| Collaborate with faculty members at the UGA's financial system and resources | 1-2 years | SAPPs executive board member | department faculty | Low dependency to other needs and tasks. |
| Offer resources guides for new members | Less than 1 year | Current SAPPs executive board member and new team member | SAPPs Constitution, collaborative platform | Will be influenced by other needs and will influence the organization tasks. |

| Need 01 - Identify the tasks of SAPPs | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Intervention | Type | Commitment Required | Resources Needed | Timeline for Implementat | Additional intervention |

| | | | | ion | s Needed for Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Update the SAPPs constitution | Non-instrucitonal | Assign members to update task member descriptions | Previous constitution and document | Update 1 month prior the change in member roles | |
| **Need 02 - Clarify the responsibility of each role in SAPPs** | | | | | |
| **Intervention** | **Type** | **Commitment Required** | **Resources Needed** | **Timeline for Implementation** | **Additional interventions Needed for Support** |
| 1. Update the SAPPs constitution | Non-instrucitonal | Assign members to update office role member descriptions | Previous constitution and document | Update 1 month prior the change in member roles | |
| 2. Conduct members meetings focused on Tifton and Griffin campus. | Non-instrucitonal | Held regular online meetings | Meeting agenda, collaborative calendar | Schedule all meetings one month after the turnover | |
| 3. Provide an annual mentorship program for SAPPs board members. | Instructional | Assign SAPPs executive board member to provide assistance | SAPPs executive board member | The first month of membership change | |
| **Need 03 - Organize methods of communication between members** | | | | | |
| **Intervention** | **Type** | **Commitment Required** | **Resources Needed** | **Timeline for Implementation** | **Additional interventions Needed for Support** |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Consolidate platforms for communication | Non-instructional | Assign a role to maintain and platform | Access to the platform with UGA account | The first thing to implement, and update twice a year. | Online platform training and guideline |
| 2. Create a social media office role position | Non-instructional | Assign a role to maintain and update on the account | social media platform | One month after the turnover; update in one week after the events or activities. | Social media management training. |
| 3. Held team building workshops. | Instructional | All member should attend the workshop | Instructor; financial funding | Two to three months after the turnover. | |
| **Need 04 - Identify the specific difficulties to collaborate with other liaison** | | | | | |
| **Intervention** | **Type** | **Commitment Required** | **Resources Needed** | **Timeline for Implementation** | **Additional interventions Needed for Support** |
| 1. Increase the number of executive board members on Tifton Campus. | Non-instructional | Recruit more members to SAPPs | Recruit process, advertising materials | The last two months before turnover | |
| 2. Holding cross-campus events seasonally. | Non-instructional | Assign members for planning event | SAPPs financial funding | The first two months of academic calendar | Increase the number of executive board members on Tifton Campus. |
| **Need 05 - Collaborate with faculty members at the UGA's financial system and resources** | | | | | |

| Intervention | Type | Commitment Required | Resources Needed | Timeline for Implementation | Additional interventions Needed for Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Update the treasurer responsibilities | Non-instructional | Assign treasurer to complete task | SAPPs constitution | First month of the academic annual calendar | Update the SAPPs constitution |
| 2. Define faculty members to assist SAPPs financial organization | Non-instructional | UGA approval for designating a employee to assist the organization | UGA funding | First month of the academic annual calendar | |
| **Need 06 - Offer resources guides for new members** | | | | | |
| **Intervention** | **Type** | **Commitment Required** | **Resources Needed** | **Timeline for Implementation** | **Additional interventions Needed for Support** |
| 1. Create a collaborative platform. | Non-instructional | Assign SAPPs member to complete task | SAPPs constitution | First month of the academic annual calendar | Update the SAPPs constitution |
| 2. Organize events resource guide files | Non-instructional | Assign SAPPs member to complete task | SAPPs constitution and event schedule | First week of the academic annual calendar | |

## Appendix 01 - Project contract

# MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING (MOU)

Between

**Diego Innocencio and Chinyu Sun**

and

***Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs)***

This is an agreement between Diego Innocencio and Chinyu Sun hereinafter called “the consultant” and *Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs)* hereinafter called “the client”.

## I. PURPOSE and SCOPE

The purpose of this MOU is to clearly identify the roles and responsibilities of each party as they relate to the implementation of the SAPPs review and reorganization. In particular, this MOU is intended to establish clear guidelines regarding the work that will be conducted.

## II. BACKGROUND

### Context

The SAPPs now consist of 7 members, including two representatives from Tifton and Griffin.
Liaisons. Since there are more students in Tifton Campus, the SAPPs member is planning to expand the society to facilitate the connection, effectiveness, and efficiency of SAPPs.

### Description of Clients

The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs) takes an important role in the department, not only connecting students between laboratories and campus, also assisting to hold seminars, events, and interviews for upcoming students.

The purpose of the SAPPs shall be to foster interaction and collegiality among students, postdoctoral associates, and faculty in the department of Plant Pathology at the University of Georgia. This organization also aims to improve

the quality of graduate and postdoctoral programs in the department and betterment of student teaching as well as professional development.

**Objectives of the project**

1. **Identify the tasks of SAPPs.**
   Due to the expanding, SAPPs will redistribute the tasks and responsibilities of each officer, including helding events, connecting departments, liaisons and SAPPs, etc.

2. **Clarify the job descriptions of officers in SAPPs.**
   Define responsibilities and divide activities by the job descriptions on SAPPs. The SAPPS works are divided into:
   - President
   - Vice-President
   - Treasurer
   - Secretary
   - Social Chair
   - Tifton Liaison
   - Griffin Liaison

## III. Consultant Responsibilities Under this MOU

The responsibilities of Diego Innocencio and Chinyu Sun as consultants:

- Meet with stakeholders of SAPP
- Design the surveys and interviews used to develop the SAPPs project.
- Analyze the data
- Provide possible suggestions and recommendations to facilitate the efficiency of the department.
- Provide recommendations related to organizational structure of SAPPs.

According to the focus of the project, which focuses on providing a needs assessment on SAPPs. The roles of  Diego Innocencio and Chinyu Sun as the consultants focus on determining the needs, or any “gap”, in which the desired task analyzed might have.

## IV. *Client* Responsibilities Under this MOU

The client’s responsibility is to provide access to contact information of some of the society members to be used for the SAPPs project. During the course of the needs assessment surveys and interviews will be used to collect data from the

members. It is the responsibility of the institution to choose and allow the selected members to participate and complete the surveys and interviews.

## V. Project Timeline

| Date | Task | Estimated Hours | Completed By |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1/29/2024 | 1st Interview with client | 1 | 1/29/2024 |
| 2/9 or 2/16 | Meet with SAPPs Team | 1-2 | 2/16/2024 |
| 2/19/2024-3/1/2024 | Design data collection tools | 30 | 3/1/2024 |
| 3/11/2024-3/22/2024 | Data Collection(may include survey, interview, etc.) | 30 | 3/22/2024 |
| 4/5/2024 | Data Analysis | 15 | 4/15/2024 |
| 4/26/2024 | Feedback, Suggestion, and Recommendation | 15 | 4/22/2024 |

### VII. Client Contact Information

*Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs)*
*Vice President : Hsiao-Chun (Johnny) Chen*
*Email address: hc19126@uga.edu*
*Phone number: 706-308-7923*

## VII. Effective Date and Signature

This MOU shall be effective upon the signature of Diego Innocencio, Chinyu Sun and *Hsiao-Chun (Johnny) Chen* authorized officials. It shall be in force from *Date* to *Date 2/1/2024 to 02/01/2025.*

Diego Innocencio, Chinyu Sun and Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology(SAPPs) indicate agreement with this MOU by their signatures.

Signatures and dates

Diego Innocencio

Diego Innocencio

_____ __01/31/2024_____
Date

Chinyu Sun

ChinyuSun

_____ __01/31/2024_____
Date

*Hsiao-Chun (Johnny) Chen*

Johnny Chen

_____ __02/01/2024_____
Date

## Appendix 02 - Document analysis data collection tool

# Document analysis data collection tool

This data collection tool was created to guide the analysis of the The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology(SAPPs) Constitution 2023-2024 document. This document provides information for new SAPPs office members about their duties and responsibilities while assuming one of the seven role positions and also informs all the necessary information to conduct meetings, events and any task related to the organization. It also provides the by-laws and guidelines for members to conduct according to UGA standards.

| Task | Yes | No | Comments |
|---|---|---|---|
| **President** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |
| **Vice President** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |
| **Treasurer** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |

| Secretary | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |
| **Social chair** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |
| **Tifton/Griffin Liaison** | | | |
| Purpose of the job role was identified | | | |
| The description of the role is well defined | | | |
| The duties of the role is well explained | | | |
| **Additional information** | | | |
| The document is well written | | | |
| The document cover all the information needed for new office members | | | |
| the document covers role position changes and for extenuating reasons | | | |

**Appendix 03 - Interview data collection tool**

# Interview data collection

# SAPPs Needs Assessment

The purpose of this interview is to collect information about the company for a needs assessment. The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs) will use the data collected in this interview to identify the most pressing issues which can be addressed in the future. This interview focuses on all SAPPs members. The interview will be conducted via Zoom, the meeting link will be provided shortly after the interview has been scheduled.

Please answer the following questions truthfully and we encourage you to describe your answers with as much detail as possible.

This interview and any files transmitted within it are confidential and intended solely for the use of the needs assessment. There are no identifiers on the survey and each individual who fills out the survey will remain anonymous. You are not obligated to answer any questions, but your answers are highly appreciated. This interview contains confidential information and is intended only for the intended individuals. If you are not the intended participant you should not disseminate, distribute or copy this interview or its contents.

**Interview questions**

| Number | Topic |
|---|---|
| | **Responsibilities** |
| **1** | What is your current position at SAPPs? |
| **2** | Do others in SAPPs understand your role within the group? |

| | |
|---|---|
| **3** | Are you familiar with other members' roles? |
| **4** | What tasks do you normally perform every day? |
| **5** | Who assigns your tasks to you? |
| **6** | How frequently do you receive new tasks? |
| **7** | Can you perform your tasks properly? If not, can you explain your issues? |
| **6** | In what format do you provide feedback for your peers and superiors? (emails, messages, meetings) |
| **7** | How frequently do you provide feedback to your peers? |
| **8** | How frequently do you receive feedback from your peers? |
| | **Communication** |

| | |
|---|---|
| **8** | How do you normally send messages to your peers? |
| **9** | Do you understand the tasks given to you? |
| **10** | How would you describe your familiarity with the technology used for communication at SAPPs? |
| **11** | Have you ever had issues with the technology used for communication at SAPPs? |
| **12** | Have you encountered any difficulties communicating because of cultural differences or language barriers? |
| **13** | How do you normally receive feedback from your peers? |
| **14** | How would you describe the  feedback that you receive by your peers? |
| **15** | What types of feedback would be beneficial to you in your role at SAPPs? |
| | **Collaboration** |
| **16** | Do you normally perform your tasks individually or in groups? |

| | |
|---|---|
| **17** | Do you provide assistance in different members' tasks? |
| **18** | Do you feel comfortable asking for assistance for tasks? If not, elaborate on your answer. |

**Appendix 04 - Survey data collection tool**

# Survey data collection

# SAPPs Needs Assessment

Please take a moment to complete the survey below. The purpose of this survey is to get your input methods of communication used in this company. The Society of Aspiring Plant Pathology (SAPPs) will use the results of this survey and other information to identify the most pressing issues which can be addressed in the future. This survey focuses on SAPPs members that do not have a managerial position. If you have previously completed this survey, please ignore this.  Remember…your opinion is important!

Please fill out the answer for the question below with the option that best describes your agreement with the statements below. The options vary from Strongly disagree in which the sentence does not represent your opinion on the subject and to strongly agree when you firmly agree with the statement.

This survey and any files transmitted within it are confidential and intended solely for the use of the needs assessment. There are no identifiers on the survey and each individual who fills out the survey will remain anonymous. You are not obligated to answer any questions, but your answers are highly appreciated. If you have received this survey in error please notify the system manager. This survey contains confidential information and is intended only for the intended individuals. If you are not the intended participant you should not disseminate, distribute or copy this survey or its contents.

**Please indicate your level of agreement with each of the following statements.**

| Email | Strongly disagree | disagree | Neutral | agree | Strongly Agree |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1-** I can effectively send messages for my peers via email | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **2** - I understand my tasks clearly when received by email | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **3** - I am familiar with the technology | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **4** - I don't have issues with cultural barriers via email | ☑ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **5 -** I don't have issues with language barriers via email | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **6** - I can convey my ideas clearly via email | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **7-** I am satisfied with the feedback I receive via email. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **8 -** I receive feedback in a satisfactory time via email | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

**Please indicate your level of agreement with each of the following statements.**

| Zoom meetings | Strongly disagree | disagree | Neutral | agree | Strongly Agree |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 -** I can effectively send messages to my peers via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **2** - I understand my tasks clearly when received verbally by zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **3 -** I understand my tasks clearly when received in the chat by zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **4** - I am familiar with the technology | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **5** - I don't have issues with cultural barriers communicating in meetings via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **6** - I don't have issues with language barriers communicating in meetings via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **7** - I can convey my ideas clearly via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **8** - I receive good feedback from my peers via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **9 -** I receive good feedback from my superiors via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **10 -** I receive feedback in a satisfactory time via zoom | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

**Please indicate your level of agreement with each of the following statements.**

| Face to face Meetings | Strongly disagree | disagree | Neutral | agree | Strongly Agree |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1-** I understand my tasks clearly when received in Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **2** - I don't have issues with cultural barriers on Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **3 -** I don't have issues with language barriers on Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **3** - I can convey my ideas clearly on Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **4** - I receive good feedback on Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| **5** - I receive feedback in a satisfactory time on Face to face Meetings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |